

First Week After Pentecost

In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis

1962 TLM: Trinity Sunday and the one divine Name

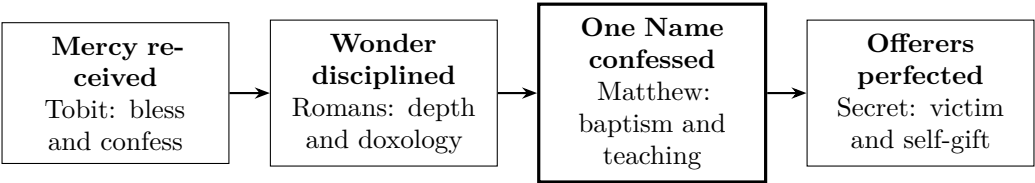
Source note. In the 1962 Missale Romanum the Sunday after Pentecost is the feast of the Most Holy Trinity. The distinct Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost, beginning *Domine, in tua misericordia speravi*, is appointed for available ferial days of the week; it is noted here to prevent its texts from being blended into the feast's proper sequence or preparation module.

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas</i> (Tob. 12:6; Ps. 8:2)	Blessing for mercy	Before explaining the mystery, the Church blesses the Trinity and remembers mercy received.
Collect	True faith: acknowledge Trinity, adore unity	Confession and protection	Firmness in the confessed faith guards the worshipper from adversity.
Epistle	Rom. 11:33-36	Unsearchable wisdom	Paul's inquiry ends in wonder and praise: all things are from, through, and unto God.
Gradual	<i>Benedictus es, Domine, qui intueris abyssos</i> (Dan. 3:55-56)	Abyss and throne	God sees the depths and reigns above the Cherubim; human unsearching yields to revealed praise.
Alleluia	<i>Benedictus es, Domine Deus patrum nostrorum</i> (Dan. 3:52)	Inherited praise	The God of the fathers is blessed for ever as the Church ascends to the Gospel.
Gospel	Matt. 28:18-20	One Name, baptism, teaching	Christ joins universal mission to baptism, commanded obedience, and his presence until the end.
Offertory	<i>Benedictus sit Deus Pater... Filius... Spiritus</i> (Tob. 12:6)	Blessing returned	The mercy proclaimed at the entrance becomes the praise carried to the altar.
Secret	<i>Sanctifica, quaesumus, Domine Deus noster ... per tui sancti nominis invocationem ... nosmetipsos ... munus aeternum</i>	The Name, victim, and offerers	The holy Name is invoked over the victim, and through the oblation the worshippers ask to be perfected as God's eternal gift.
Communion	<i>Benedicimus Deum caeli</i> (Tob. 12:6)	Public thanksgiving	Reception issues in confession before all the living.
Postcommunion	<i>Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae</i>	Sacrament and confession	Sacramental reception and Trinitarian confession are asked to profit body and soul.

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Romans 11 confesses judgments that cannot be searched out; Matthew 28 records Christ's authority, command to baptize and teach, and promise to remain with the apostles until the consummation of the age.
Allegorical	The one baptismal Name reveals the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost and gathers the nations into the teaching and sacramental life of the Church.
Moral	The baptized are not merely to repeat the formula but to observe all that Christ commanded; the Secret extends that obedience into the offering of the self.
Anagogical	Christ's presence reaches to the consummation of the age, while the Secret asks that the worshippers become an eternal gift and Paul's doxology directs all things to God's glory.

Blessing Before Mastery

Trinity Sunday does not begin by inviting the worshipper to construct a model of God. It begins with Tobit’s command to bless the Trinity for mercy shown, then places Paul’s astonishment, Daniel’s praise, and Christ’s baptismal mandate inside that prior thanksgiving. The intellectual order is therefore also a spiritual order: gift, wonder, confession, offering, and mission.



Editorial liturgical synthesis. The sequence above is this guide’s reading of the appointed formulary. The patristic witnesses below directly explain particular biblical texts or illuminate the doctrine of sacrifice; none is being claimed as an author of the Roman proper.

The Collect supplies the rule of reading
The prayer asks for true faith to <i>acknowledge</i> the glory of the eternal Trinity, to <i>adore</i> the Unity in the power of majesty, and to be guarded by steadfastness in that faith. Knowledge is ordered to worship, and worship asks for perseverance. Mystery exceeds comprehension without becoming either contradiction or silence.

Romans 11: Wonder Inside the Economy of Mercy

Paul’s cry, “O the depth,” concludes Romans 9–11 rather than interrupting the letter with an abstract reflection. He has traced Israel’s privileges and stumbling, the Gentiles’ unexpected grafting, the warning against Gentile boasting, and the divine purpose to have mercy upon all. The judgments are unsearchable precisely because the apostle has followed a real saving economy farther than creaturely foresight can govern it.

St. John Chrysostom — <i>Homily 19 on Romans</i>
Commenting directly on Romans 11:33–36, Chrysostom says that Paul knows there is a depth but does not claim to know its measure. He follows the reversals of Jew and Gentile, marvels that apparent opposites are governed by one wisdom, and ends where Paul ends: God is no debtor, because every creature first receives from him. Wonder is not a retreat from exegesis; it is exegesis brought to the limit set by divine freedom and beneficence.

Paul’s phrase	Chrysostom’s direct emphasis	Work within this feast
<i>O altitudo</i>	The apostle can recognize the reality of the depth without measuring it.	Confession is neither mastery nor agnosticism: what is revealed is truly known and inexhaustible.
Unsearchable judgments and ways	The surprising dispensations toward Israel and the nations display one wise power through reversals.	The Gospel’s mission to all nations is heard within salvation history, not as a detached slogan of universality.
Who first gave to him?	God is always the first benefactor and never a creature’s debtor.	Tobit’s remembered mercy and the altar’s offering both begin in prior gift.
From, through, and unto him	Paul’s inquiry resolves in glory rather than possession.	Doxology is the proper terminus of theological attention and the beginning of obedient worship.

An exegetical guardrail

Romans 11:36 speaks doxologically of God in its immediate grammar. The verse is fittingly contemplated on Trinity Sunday, but *ex ipso, per ipsum, in ipso* must not be mechanically assigned as three grammatical labels for Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. The Church's Trinitarian confession is governed explicitly by the baptismal Name in Matthew 28 and by the wider rule of faith.

Psalm 8 and Daniel: Praise Learns the Name

The Introit joins Tobit's thanksgiving to "O Lord our Lord, how admirable is thy name in the whole earth" (Ps. 8:2). Augustine's exposition is direct commentary on that appointed verse, although not on its later placement in this Mass.

St. Augustine — *Exposition on Psalm 8, 4–8*

Augustine reads the admirable Name in all the earth in the light of Christ's exaltation, whose glory is above the heavens. The psalm then places praise in the mouths of the little ones before mature comprehension. For Augustine, faith and praise are not substitutes for knowledge; they are the creature's truthful beginning before a glory that exceeds every verbal account.

The Gradual and Alleluia continue Daniel 3's blessing from abyss to throne and from the God of the fathers to everlasting praise. The Gradual does not solve Paul's unsearchable depth. It changes the observer's position: what the creature cannot sound is entirely beheld by the Lord enthroned above the Cherubim. The Alleluia then makes inherited praise ready for Christ's command to carry the one Name to the nations.

Chant movement	Textual action	Editorial resonance across the formulary
Introit	Mercy is remembered and the admirable Name blessed throughout the earth.	Grace precedes inquiry; the earth-wide Name anticipates the Gospel's nations.
Gradual	God beholds the abysses and reigns from the blessed throne of glory.	Paul's "depth" is placed under divine sight rather than human control.
Alleluia	The God of the fathers is blessed for ever.	The mission to the nations neither erases Israel nor invents another God.
Offertory and Communion	Father, Son, and Holy Ghost are blessed; God is confessed before all the living.	Praise received from Scripture is returned at the altar and reopened toward public witness.

Matthew 28: One Name, Three Inseparable Persons

The Gospel's grammar holds unity and distinction together. The singular "Name" names Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; baptism is followed by teaching observance; the command to all nations rests on the risen Son's universal authority and continuing presence. The Fathers use this text not as an isolated proof but as a rule for Christian initiation, confession, worship, and life.

Witness and locus	Direct reading of Matthew 28	Doctrinal contribution	Boundary retained
St. Hilary, <i>De Trinitate</i> II.1–2	Hilary calls the command a comprehensive saving rule whose words, actions, and sequence join the Creator, the Only-begotten, and the Gift.	The three are not separable stages or unequal powers; baptism introduces the believer into their supreme union.	Hilary immediately admits the poverty of theological language: heresy makes speech necessary, but speech never contains the mystery.

Witness and locus	Direct reading of Matthew 28	Doctrinal contribution	Boundary retained
St. Basil, <i>De Spiritu Sancto</i> 10.24; 12.26, 28; 27.68	The Spirit's coordination with Father and Son in baptism cannot be reconciled with demoting him to a creaturely rank. Faith and baptism are completed in the same named confession.	The baptismal formula governs equal confession and doxology; saving regeneration is from Father, Son, and Holy Ghost without dividing the Spirit from their communion.	Basil's argument answers anti-Spirit controversy. It should not be reduced to a bare observation that three nouns occur in one sentence.
St. Gregory Nazianzen, <i>Oration</i> 40.41, 45	Gregory confesses one Godhead and power in three, then returns to Christ's command to disciple and baptize in Father, Son, and Holy Ghost.	The three share the common Name of Godhead; works must be built upon this dogmatic foundation.	Gregory does not oppose doctrine to conduct. Baptismal confession requires a life fitted to the gift received.

The appointed Preface as liturgical confession

The Preface of the Most Holy Trinity confesses one Lord not in the singularity of one Person but in Trinity of one substance: distinction belongs to the Persons, unity to essence, equality to majesty. This is the feast's appointed liturgical context, not another row of the proper and not evidence that Hilary, Basil, or Gregory authored the formulary.

The order "make disciples, baptizing, teaching them to observe" prevents two opposite reductions. Baptism is not a badge detached from formation, and moral formation is not a program detached from incorporation into the revealed Name. Gregory's call to build good works upon dogma closely matches the Gospel's own movement from initiation to observance. Christ's final promise keeps both mission and obedience within presence: the sender remains with the sent until the consummation.

The Secret: The Name, the Victim, and the Offerers

The newly restored Secret is not a generic prayer over gifts. Its syntax makes a compact sacramental argument: the holy Name is invoked over the victim, and through that oblation the worshippers ask to be perfected as God's eternal gift.

Latin hinge	Immediate force	Theological movement
<i>per tui sancti nominis invocationem</i>	Sanctification is asked through invocation of God's holy Name.	The Name confessed in baptism is invoked at the altar; neither use is a magical sound detached from faith and divine action.
<i>huius oblationis hostiam</i>	The direct object of <i>sanctifica</i> is the victim of this oblation.	The prayer first asks God to sanctify what is offered, not to certify an autonomous human achievement.
<i>et per eam nosmetipsos</i>	"And through it, us ourselves": the petition passes through the oblation to the offerers.	External gift and interior self-offering are joined without being confused.
<i>tibi perfice munus aeternum</i>	God is asked to perfect the worshippers for himself as an eternal gift.	The altar aims beyond a momentary sentiment toward an ecclesial, enduring consecration.

St. Augustine — *City of God* X.5–6, 20

Augustine is not commenting on this Secret. He supplies precise doctrinal illumination: visible sacrifice signifies the invisible offering that unites a person to God; mercy is true sacrifice when ordered to that union; body and soul are offered as the mind is transformed; and the whole redeemed city is offered through Christ the High Priest. In the altar's sacrament the Church learns to offer herself through the one who is both priest and sacrifice.

Gregory Nazianzen's baptismal exhortation in *Oration 40.25* provides an analogue from Christian initiation: the baptized is to offer himself and clothe himself with Christ, making conduct answer the sacramental gift. It is not direct exegesis of the Secret, but it helps explain why invocation of the baptismal Name can lead to a petition concerning *nosmetipsos*.

Sacrifice without collapse

The victim and the congregation are not interchangeable objects, and the Church does not become Christ by nature. Christ's unique priestly self-offering makes ecclesial self-offering possible. Augustine's account preserves the order: the many become one body in the High Priest and, through him, offer themselves to God.

Charity: Participation, Not a Diagram

Augustine's *De Trinitate* VIII.7.10–VIII.10.14 moves from righteous love of the brother to the confession that God is love, and then to lover, beloved, and love. Read in full, the passage is more disciplined than its memorable phrases sometimes suggest.

Augustine's step	Spiritual claim	Guardrail
Love of the righteous brother	True love includes readiness to give oneself for the brethren and makes the unseen God known through the charity he gives.	Sentiment without righteousness or self-gift is not Augustine's charity.
God is love	Brotherly love is from God and gives real participation in divine life.	Created charity is not the divine essence captured as a psychological object.
Lover, beloved, love	Augustine identifies a genuine triadic starting point for contemplation.	He explicitly treats it as a beginning of inquiry, not a discovery that contains or proves the Trinity.

The Mass therefore refuses to leave Trinity at the level of an elegant schema. Baptism obliges observance; the Secret asks that the offerers themselves become gift; Communion returns to public thanksgiving; and the Postcommunion asks that sacramental reception and confession advance the salvation of body and soul. Charity is the graced form in which confessed truth becomes lived communion, not an alternative to the singular Name and three Persons revealed by Christ.

A patristic listening sequence for the Mass

1. At the Introit, receive mercy before attempting explanation. With Augustine on Psalm 8, let praise and faith begin where exhaustive speech cannot.
2. In the Collect, keep acknowledgment, adoration, and steadfastness together; true confession asks to become a stable life.
3. In Romans, follow Chrysostom through Israel, the nations, divine priority, and doxology. Do not detach “depth” from the economy that occasions Paul’s wonder.
4. At the Gradual and Alleluia, hear the humanly unsearchable abyss placed beneath God’s sight and the inherited praise of the fathers carried forward.
5. In Matthew, attend to the singular Name, the three named Persons, baptism, teaching, observance, mission, and Christ’s enduring presence as one saving mandate.
6. At the Offertory and Secret, return blessing to its giver. Hear the petition move from invocation, to victim, through the oblation, to the offerers perfected as enduring gift.
7. At Communion, confess God before all the living; in the Postcommunion, ask that sacrament and Trinitarian confession bear fruit in body and soul.

Source boundaries to retain

- Chrysostom on Romans 11, Hilary, Basil, and Gregory on Matthew 28, and Augustine on Psalm 8 are **direct patristic exegesis** of appointed biblical texts, though not commentaries on this Roman formulary.
- Augustine’s *City of God* and Gregory’s baptismal self-offering are **doctrinal and sacramental illumination** of the Secret, not evidence of its authorship.
- The Tobit recurrence, the chant-to-Gospel movement, and the Secret’s place within the whole sequence are **editorial liturgical syntheses** controlled by the actual texts.
- Augustine’s love-language gives an analogical starting point. It must not collapse the divine Persons into human faculties, relations, emotions, or parts.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis*, Introit through Postcommunion, with the appointed Preface of the Most Holy Trinity; local OCR temporal corpus identified in the README. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification; psalm numbering follows the Vulgate.
- Holy Scripture: Tobit 12:6; Psalm 8:2; Daniel 3:52, 55–56; Romans 9–11, especially 11:25–36; Matthew 28:16–20.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 19 on Romans*, on Romans 11:33–36, working public-domain text.
- St. Hilary of Poitiers, *De Trinitate* II.1–2, working public-domain text.
- St. Basil the Great, *De Spiritu Sancto* 10.24; 12.26, 28; 27.68, working public-domain text.
- St. Gregory Nazianzen, *Oration 40*, 25, 41, 45, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 8*, 4–8, working public-domain text; *De Trinitate* VIII.7.10–VIII.10.14, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *City of God* X.5–6, 20, visible sacrifice, ecclesial self-offering, and the one High Priest.